

Lesson 3: Build a Service Package

What You'll Do Today

In Lesson 2, you chose one service you could offer — something like designing graphics, tutoring a subject, editing videos, building a simple website, writing resumes, or organizing photos. Today you're going to turn that idea into a real, written **service package**: a short document that says exactly what a customer gets when they hire you, and exactly what they don't.

By the end of class, you'll have a one-page package for your own service, ready to actually use.

Why This Matters

Imagine you hired someone to paint your bedroom, and they finished — but didn't paint the closet, because "you didn't say the closet." Were they wrong? Maybe not, technically. But you're still annoyed, because you assumed it was included.

That's the exact problem a service package solves. It's not about sounding fancy or professional-sounding — it's about making sure you and your customer agree, in writing, on what's being delivered *before* any money or work changes hands. Almost every argument between a freelancer and a customer comes down to one thing: something was assumed but never actually agreed on.

A clear package protects **you** too. If a customer asks for something outside what you listed, you're not being difficult by saying "that's not part of this package" — you already told them what was included, in writing, before they paid.

The Parts of a Service Package

A simple, first service package has five parts:

Part	What it answers
Deliverable	What exact thing will the customer receive? (Format, quantity, detail)
What's Included	Everything the customer gets for the agreed price
What's Not Included	Things customers might assume are included, but aren't
Turnaround Time	How long it will take, and starting from when
Revision Policy	How many changes/edits are included after the first delivery

Deliverable

This is the actual "thing" you hand over. Be specific — not "a logo," but "1 logo design, delivered as a PNG file and a PDF file, by email." Vague deliverables cause more disagreements than almost anything else in this package.

What's Included

A bulleted list of everything covered by the price. Be generous but realistic — only list what you can actually deliver reliably, every time.

What's Not Included

This is not rude — it's protective. It tells the customer what's outside this package, so they're not surprised later, and so you're not pressured into free extra work. Example: a tutoring package might exclude "grading homework" even though it includes "reviewing homework together during the session."

Turnaround Time

How long the work will take — and importantly, starting from *what*. "3 days" is incomplete. "3 business days from when I receive your logo files" is complete, because it protects you from delays that are the customer's fault (like them being slow to send you what you need).

Revision Policy

How many rounds of changes are included after you deliver the first version. This should be a specific number — never "unlimited." Unlimited revisions sound generous but actually hurt everyone: they remove the customer's reason to give clear feedback the first time, and they can eat unlimited amounts of your unpaid time.

Key Terms

- **Scope** — the exact boundary of what a service does and doesn't cover.
- **Deliverable** — the actual file, product, or result the customer receives.
- **Turnaround** — how long the work takes to complete, from an agreed starting point.
- **Revision policy** — the rules for how many changes are included after the first delivery.
- **Tier** — a version of a service at a different price/scope level (e.g. Basic vs. Standard). Not used in this lesson — we're building one simple package first.

Worked Example: Maya's Post Graphics Package

Here's a complete, filled-out example for a fictional student, Maya, who offers Instagram post graphics for small local businesses.

Service Name: Maya's Post Graphics

What's Included: - 3 custom Instagram post graphics using the business's logo and colors - Business name and short text added to each graphic - Files sized correctly for Instagram feed posts (1080x1080px)

What's Not Included: - Posting the graphics to Instagram - Video or Reels content - Additional graphics beyond the 3 included (available as a new order)

Deliverable Format: 3 PNG files, delivered by email

Turnaround Time: 3 business days from when the business sends their logo and color preferences

Revision Policy: Up to 1 round of revisions included (e.g. text or color changes). Additional revision rounds are a small added fee.

Notice: every line answers a question a real customer would have. Nothing is left for either side to guess.

Step-by-Step Activity

1. Open the Worksheet (Google Docs, Canva, or Notion — your choice).
2. Write your **Service Name** — short and specific to what you actually do.
3. Write your **Deliverable Format** first. Ask yourself: "If I couldn't answer any follow-up questions, would someone know exactly what they're getting — format, quantity, and how it's delivered?"
4. List 3–5 things **Included**.
5. List at least 2 things **Not Included** — think about what a customer might assume, but that would actually take extra time or a different skill.
6. Write your **Turnaround Time**, and make sure you state what it starts counting from.
7. Write your **Revision Policy** with a specific number of rounds — not zero, not unlimited.
8. Read the whole thing back as if you were the customer. Does every line make sense on its own?
9. Save your document — you'll build on it in the next lesson.

Knowledge Checks

1. What are the two biggest problems with saying "unlimited revisions" in a service package?
2. Why does listing "what's not included" protect both the customer and the freelancer, not just the freelancer?
3. What's wrong with a turnaround time that just says "3 days" with no starting point?
4. Give an example of a vague deliverable and rewrite it to be specific.
5. True or false: a good service package should include as many extras as possible to seem like a better deal. Explain your answer.

Reflection Prompts

1. Which part of your package (Included, Not Included, Turnaround, or Revision Policy) was hardest to write, and why do you think that one was harder?
2. Think of a time you were a customer somewhere and something wasn't what you expected. What could have been written down ahead of time to prevent that?

3. If a customer asked you for something outside your "Not Included" list, how would you respond in a way that's clear but still friendly?

Submission Instructions

- Save your completed Service Package worksheet in Google Docs, Canva, or Notion (whichever tool you used).
- Name your file: [Your Name] - Service Package - [Your Service]
- Share the link or file with your instructor by the end of class, using the class submission method (Notion page, email, or shared folder as directed by your instructor).
- Bring this document to Lesson 4 — you'll build directly on it.